



P 49 · 20 PAGES, 30 SCRIPTS

The Asking for Help Script Pack

Twenty pages, thirty scripts for asking specific people for specific help. Meals, childcare, eldercare, errands, emotional support, money, home help, visits. Plus the "when they say no" page, the "when they say yes" page, and a thank-you script library. The inverse companion to the Saying No Script Pack.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

Asking for help is harder than saying no.

Saying no is one word. Asking for help is a request that lands on another person. It risks rejection. It risks the wrong help showing up. It risks looking like you cannot manage on your own. So most people who need help do not ask. They white-knuckle through, or they wait for someone to offer, which mostly doesn't happen.

This pack is the words. Thirty scripts. Specific people. Specific requests. Specific times. Easy ways for the other person to say no without it being awkward.

Because the difference between a successful ask and a failed one is rarely the relationship. It is the specificity.

Soothemade

This is a planning tool. Asking for help around financial matters does not replace a financial planner. Asking for emotional help does not replace a therapist. The scripts route to professionals where relevant.

How to use this pack

- Find the script that fits the kind of help you need.
- Substitute the specifics for your situation.
- Send it (text, email, or phone, depending on who).
- The person can say yes or no. Both are okay. The script is designed to make “no” easy too.

A small principle: ask early. Ask before you collapse. The version of you that asks at week 4 is asking from a stronger position than the version of you that finally asks at week 8 after a meltdown.

The structure of a good ask

Every good ask has four parts.

1. SPECIFIC PERSON

Not "anyone." Not "the group chat." A specific person, by name.

2. SPECIFIC REQUEST

Not "help." A specific thing.

"Could you bring dinner Thursday."

"Could you watch the baby for one hour Tuesday afternoon."

"Could you come sit with me Saturday morning."

3. SPECIFIC TIME

A date or a time window. Not "sometime soon."

"This Thursday around 6pm."

"Tuesday between 2 and 3pm."

"Saturday at 10am."

4. EASY EXIT

A clause that makes "no" comfortable.

"Totally fine if you cannot."

"No worries if you have other plans."

"If this doesn't work, no pressure at all."

EVERY SCRIPT IN THIS PACK FOLLOWS THIS STRUCTURE. YOURS CAN TOO.

Meals

The most common, most useful kind of help.

SCRIPT 1, MEAL DROP-OFF (to a friend)

"Hi [name], I am still getting our footing here in the early weeks with the baby. Would you be able to drop off a meal sometime this week? Any night between [date] and [date] would be great. Even a takeout pickup at your favorite spot would be amazing. No pressure if this doesn't work."

SCRIPT 2, MEAL DROP-OFF (to a family member)

"Mom / [name], I need a hand with dinners this week. Could you bring something Thursday around 6? If you're up for it, dinner would help us so much. No need to stay long, we just need food that we did not have to cook."

SCRIPT 3, MEAL TRAIN COORDINATION (to a close friend who can organize)

"Hi [name], would you be willing to set up a small meal-train link for us? We don't want a huge production. Maybe a meal every other day for two weeks. I'll send you the list of who to invite if you are open to it. If this is too much to coordinate, no pressure, I'll figure something else out."

SCRIPT 4, GROCERY RUN

"[Name], I'm at the point where the grocery run is the thing I can't quite manage. Would you be willing to pick up a list for me this week? I'll Venmo you for everything. Could mean a lot of help, no pressure if it doesn't work."

SCRIPT 5, PROFESSIONAL DELIVERY

"[Name], I know this is random, but is there a chance I could ask you to send us a few weeks of grocery delivery or meal-kit subscription as our baby gift? It would be the best gift in the world right now. Of course if not, no pressure at all."

Childcare

For someone watching the kids, even briefly.

SCRIPT 6, ONE HOUR FOR A PARENT'S OWN APPOINTMENT

"[Name], I have a doctor's appointment Tuesday at 2pm. Could you come over and be with [baby] for one hour, 1:45 to 2:45? They will probably nap most of that time. I'll have everything set up. Totally fine if you can't."

SCRIPT 7, MORNING FOR A REST

"Mom / [name], could you come over Saturday morning, say 9 to 11, and just hold [baby] / be with [older kid] while I sleep? No need to do anything. Just be there with them. This would help more than you know."

SCRIPT 8, KID PICK-UP FROM SCHOOL/DAYCARE

"[Name], something came up and I need to be at [appointment] Thursday afternoon. Would you be able to pick [kid] up from [school/daycare] at 3pm and keep them for an hour or two until I can get there? I'll write [school] to add you to the pickup list. No worries if not."

SCRIPT 9, AN HOUR FOR A SHOWER

"[Name], this is small but real, I haven't showered in three days. Could you come over for one hour [day] so I can shower, eat something, and breathe? I am not asking you to do anything except be in the house with me."

SCRIPT 10, OVERNIGHT (for the brave ask)

"[Name], I am wondering if you would be open to keeping [older kid] overnight on [date]. [Partner] and I really need one stretch of sleep. They have school the next morning so they would just need their backpack and breakfast. Completely understand if this is too much to ask."

Eldercare

For the adult child caring for an aging parent.

SCRIPT 11, COMPANY FOR THE PARENT FOR AN AFTERNOON

"[Sibling name], could you spend the afternoon with Mom / Dad on [date]? I have not had a day off in weeks. I'd be so grateful if you could be there from say 11 to 4. They would love to see you. Let me know if that works."

SCRIPT 12, TAKING OVER FOR A WEEKEND

"[Sibling], I am asking for a real weekend off. Could you take over for the weekend of [date]? You don't have to be at the house the whole time, but you would be the primary point of contact for any issues with Mom / Dad, including any calls from the facility / home aide. Two days. I need a real break."

SCRIPT 13, ACCOMPANYING TO AN APPOINTMENT

"[Name], Mom has an appointment with [specialist] on [date] at [time]. Could you come with us? I need a second pair of ears in the room, and someone who can drive home if I am too rattled by what they tell us."

Errands

The small daily logistics.

SCRIPT 14, PHARMACY OR PICK-UP

"[Name], could you grab a [prescription / package / dry cleaning] for me this week? It's just at [location]. I'll Venmo you for any pickup fee. Totally fine if you can't."

SCRIPT 15, RIDE TO AN APPOINTMENT

"[Name], I have an appointment [date] at [time] across town. Could you drive me? I don't think I should drive home after. I'll buy you coffee on the way. No worries if you're busy."

SCRIPT 16, AN AIRPORT RUN

"[Name], I have to get to the airport at [time] on [date]. Any chance you can drive me / pick me up? I know it's a lift, no pressure at all if not."

Emotional support

When you need a person, not a task.

SCRIPT 17, JUST TALKING ON THE PHONE

"[Name], I am having a hard week. Could you call me sometime in the next day or two and just let me talk? You don't have to fix anything. I just need to hear your voice."

SCRIPT 18, A VISIT WHERE YOU DO NOTHING TOGETHER

"[Name], could you come over [day] and just be here? We don't need to do anything. We can sit on the couch. We can fold laundry. I am tired of being alone with my own thoughts."

SCRIPT 19, A WALK

"[Name], could we walk [date] at [time]? An hour, somewhere we both like. I just need to be outside with another adult for a bit."

SCRIPT 20, A CRY OVER TEA

"[Name], I am not okay. Can I come over [time] and cry over tea? You don't have to do anything. I just need to be near you for a bit."

A NOTE: IF YOU ARE STRUGGLING IN A WAY THAT IS BIGGER THAN A FRIEND CAN HOLD, A THERAPIST IS A DIFFERENT TYPE OF ASK. ASKING FOR HELP INCLUDES ASKING FOR PROFESSIONAL HELP WHEN THE WEIGHT IS LARGER THAN ANY FRIEND OUGHT TO HANDLE. CRISIS LINES IN THE US: 988. UK: 116 123. CANADA: 9-8-8.

Money

The hardest ask category. Even the scripts here come with a note that financial professionals exist.

SCRIPT 21, ASKING A FAMILY MEMBER FOR A LOAN

"[Name], I am in a tight spot and would like to ask you for a short-term loan. I am looking for \$[amount], to be repaid by [date] on [terms]. I would like to put this in writing so it's clear for both of us. I will completely understand if this is not possible. I want to ask in a way that respects our relationship either way."

SCRIPT 22, ASKING A FRIEND TO COVER A SHARED EXPENSE TEMPORARILY

"[Name], I am cash-flow tight right now. Could you cover my half of [shared expense] this month? I'll pay you back by [date]. Totally fine if not, I'll figure it out otherwise."

SCRIPT 23, ASKING FOR HELP FROM A PROFESSIONAL OR EMPLOYER

"[Name / HR], I am dealing with a temporary financial strain and wanted to ask if [the company] has any short-term assistance, advance, or hardship programs available. Even pointing me to the right resource would help."

A NOTE: BEFORE ASKING FAMILY OR FRIENDS FOR MONEY, CONSIDER WHETHER A FINANCIAL PLANNER, A CREDIT-COUNSELING SERVICE, OR A SOCIAL WORKER COULD HELP YOU SEE OPTIONS YOU MIGHT NOT KNOW EXIST. MONEY ASKS BETWEEN INDIVIDUALS CAN STRAIN RELATIONSHIPS. THE PROFESSIONAL ROUTE IS SOMETIMES KINDER.

Home help

Cleaning, repairs, lawn, the things that build up.

SCRIPT 24, A HOUSE-CLEANING HAND

"[Name], could you help me deep-clean the house [day]? Even just two hours together. I'll make us lunch after. I need company, not a magic act."

SCRIPT 25, A SMALL REPAIR

"[Name], I know you're handy. Would you be willing to come help me with [specific repair: a leaky faucet, a curtain rod, hanging shelves] sometime in the next two weeks? I'll cover the parts and feed you afterward."

SCRIPT 26, LAUNDRY HELP

"[Name], any chance you could come over Saturday and help me get through the laundry pile? It's gotten out of hand. We can do it together. I'll provide snacks."

SCRIPT 27, ORGANIZING A ROOM

"[Name], I want to attack [the kid's closet / the garage / the pantry] this month and I would not get it done alone. Could you spend an afternoon with me on it? Sunday or Saturday."

Visit

The “just come over” ask.

SCRIPT 28, COMING OVER WITHOUT EXPECTATIONS

"[Name], can you come over [day] and hang out for a few hours?
I do not want to leave the house. We can watch a movie / sit on
the porch / drink coffee. Bring nothing. Just come."

SCRIPT 29, A VIDEO CALL

"[Name], could we do a video call this week? I miss seeing your
face. Even half an hour would help. Tell me what works for you."

SCRIPT 30, "WILL YOU SIT WITH ME"

"[Name], I am not feeling great. Will you come over and sit with
me for an hour? You don't have to talk."

A REMINDER: THE THIRTY SCRIPTS ARE TEMPLATES. EDIT FREELY. THE
NUMBER OF PEOPLE WHO WILL SAY YES IS HIGHER THAN YOU THINK. THE
NUMBER WHO WILL SAY NO IS ALSO REAL AND DOES NOT MEAN ANYTHING ABOUT
YOU OR ABOUT THEM.

When they say no

Sometimes the answer will be no. That has to be okay, or asking does not work.

WHAT TO SAY BACK WHEN SOMEONE DECLINES

"Totally understood, thank you for letting me know."

"No worries at all, I appreciate you considering it."

"I get it, thanks for being honest."

WHAT NOT TO SAY

- "Are you sure?" (Pressures them.)
- "It's fine, I'll just do it myself." (Guilt-trippy.)
- "I just thought you would want to help." (Manipulative.)

WHEN MULTIPLE PEOPLE SAY NO

That is information, not a verdict.

Sometimes it means:

- Your network is stretched thin (their lives are also hard)
- You need a different network for this kind of help
- You need a paid version of this help (a postpartum doula, a respite worker, a cleaner, a meal-delivery service)

WHEN NO ONE TO ASK COMES TO MIND

That is its own data. Worth talking to a therapist or social worker about. Isolation is a real problem, and there are services designed for people without local networks.

A REMINDER FOR EITHER CASE: PAID HELP IS HELP. IT IS NOT A FAILURE OF YOUR NETWORK. IT IS A DIFFERENT TOOL.

When they say yes

The “yes” needs to be received well so they can do it again.

WHAT TO SAY BACK WHEN SOMEONE SAYS YES

"Oh, thank you. This is going to help so much."

"I really appreciate it. [Specific thing: I'll see you Thursday at 6, no need to bring anything else]."

"This is the kindest thing. Truly."

WHAT TO MAKE EASY FOR THEM

- Tell them exactly where to be and when.
- If they're bringing food, tell them what counts as a successful meal in your house. They will guess wrong otherwise.
- If they're watching the kid, leave a one-page note with what the kid eats, naps, calms with, gets scared of.
- If they're running an errand, send the list with quantities and brands you trust.

The friend who feels successful doing one ask is the friend who says yes to the next ask.

WHAT TO NOT DO

- Do not change your mind at the last minute unless something genuinely came up. The friend who arrived to find you "all set" after preparing for two hours will be less available next time.
- Do not over-apologize while they are there. Apologizing 20 times for "putting them out" makes them feel awkward. One thank-you at the start, one at the end, in between just be present.

THANK-YOU AFTER

- A text the next day with one specific thank-you.
- A small handwritten note for the bigger asks.
- A small reciprocal favor when you are back on your feet.

THE GOAL IS NOT SCOREKEEPING. THE GOAL IS A RELATIONSHIP THAT CAN HOLD MUTUAL HELP OVER A LIFETIME.

Thank-you script library

For when the help has happened.

TEXT, NEXT-DAY THANK-YOU

"Hey, just wanted to say thank you again for [specific thing].
It really helped. I owe you one."

TEXT, A WEEK LATER

"Still thinking about how much your [help] meant. Thank you."

WRITTEN NOTE, FOR BIGGER HELP

"Dear [Name],

I want you to know what you did meant more than I could say in the moment. [One specific detail of the help they gave.] I will not forget it.

With love and thanks,
[Your name]"

VOICE NOTE OR CALL, FOR THE BIGGEST HELP

Sometimes the right thank-you is your voice. Not a text. Tell them.

A SMALL REPAY GIFT (when ready)

- A meal you make for them later.
- A book you know they will love.
- Childcare for them when their season turns hard.
- Something specific to the kind of help they gave.

THE MOST IMPORTANT REPAY IS THIS: THE NEXT TIME THIS PERSON SAYS YES TO HELP YOU, SAY YES BACK WHEN THEY NEED YOU. THE RECIPROCITY IS WHAT TURNS A FAVOR INTO A RELATIONSHIP.

A final note

You asked.

That is the hardest part. Not the receiving of help. Not the thanking afterward. The asking.

You did the thing that people who do not ask never do. You named a need to another person. You gave them the dignity of being asked. That is its own gift to them, even if they said no.

The next time will be slightly easier. The time after that, slightly more.

The thirty scripts are templates. The way you use them is yours. The relationships you build with these asks will outlast this season.

You are not alone, even when the work feels like it. The asking is the bridge.

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Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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